

1945 Declaration of independence.

1945–49 Nationalist guerrilla war.

1949 Dutch grant independence under President Sukarno.

1950 Chancellor Soumokil declares the Molucca Islands' independence. The army is sent in and crushes the rebellion.

1955 Bandung plays host to a meeting of heads of government that gives rise to the Non-Aligned Movement.

1957 Sukarno introduces authoritarian "Guided Democracy," based on indigenous procedures.

1958 Leaders in western Sumatra mount a direct challenge to Jakarta and declare themselves the Revolutionary Government of the Republic of Indonesia. The rebellion is quickly suppressed.

1962 The Dutch agree to hand over Irian Jaya (West Papua) to Indonesia after a transition period administered by the UN. Indonesia hosts the Fourth Asian Games.

1963 Indonesia assumes control of Irian Jaya. Indonesia announces policy of "Konfrontasi" with Malaysia.

1965 Communist PKI alliance with military ends. Army crushes abortive coup and acts to eliminate PKI. Up to 1 million people are killed. Indonesian oil deposits are nationalized.

1966 Sukarno hands over emergency power to General Suharto, who reverses many of Sukarno's policies. Indonesia rejoins the UN.

1967 Indonesia plays leading role in the creation of the Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN).

1968 Suharto becomes president.

1971 Students protest against the corrupt generals ruling the country.

1975 Invasion of East Timor, which becomes the 27th province in 1976.

1979 The Transmigrasi project is initiated, and over 2 million people are transported to other islands to ease overcrowding on Java.

1984 Muslim protests in Jakarta.

1989 Unrest in Java and Sumbawa. Indonesia and Australia sign an agreement over the exploitation of resources in the seas between the two countries.

1991 Troops massacre proindependence demonstrators in East Timor.

1996 Antigovernment demonstrations in Jakarta.

1997 Economic recession, as a result of which the Indonesian rupiah plummets in value. The region suffers from widespread smog caused by forest fires.

1998 Suharto resigns amid unrest. Replaced by B. J. Habibie. Five students are killed in violent clashes with anti-insurrection forces.

1999 Free elections won by opposition leader Megawati Sukarnoputri. East Timor referendum backing independence triggers violent backlash. UN appoints transitional authority. Abdurrahman Wahid elected president, Megawati named vice president. Wahid offers Aceh greater autonomy.

2001 Wahid removed, amid allegations of corruption and incompetence, to be replaced by Megawati.

2002 East Timor becomes independent. A bomb attack in Bali kills 202 people. A peace treaty is signed in Geneva between the government and the Free Aceh Movement (GAM).

2003 Peace talks break down, and a military offensive is mounted against GAM. Three men are sentenced to death for their role in the Bali bombing.

2004 Former general Susilo Bambang Yudhoyono wins first-ever elections to choose a president directly. Tsunami leaves over 200,000 dead or missing. The region of Aceh is by far the worst hit.

2005 Peace is agreed between the government and GAM. GAM disarms and government troops withdraw from Aceh.

2006 A powerful earthquake and tsunami kill thousands on Java.

2007 The alleged leader of the Islamist militant group Jemaah Islamia is captured.

2008 Former president Suharto dies. A joint Indonesian–East Timorese Truth Commission report blames Indonesia for human rights violations on East Timor in 1999. President Yudhoyono issues a statement expressing "regret." Three militants convicted for the 2002 Bali bombings are executed.

2009 President Yudhoyono is reelected. His Democratic Party receives an increased vote share in the general election.

«238–39 Trade and Empire
«350–51 Colonial Resistance
«412–13 End of the Colonial Era

East Timor



After a bloody conflict, the former Portuguese colony won independence from Indonesia in 1999.

1200s–1400s The Javanese-based Majapahit Empire extends its control over the Indonesian archipelago, including Timor.

1500s The Portuguese arrive and settle on the island of Timor, using it as a trading post and a source of sandalwood.

1613 Dutch capture Portuguese base on Solor and expand their control over western Timor, confining the Portuguese to the eastern half of the island.

1859 A treaty between the Dutch and Portuguese codifies the relationship between the two colonial powers of Timor. The final boundaries are not delineated until 1914.

1942–45 The Japanese occupy the island of Timor. At the end of World War II, the Portuguese regain sovereignty over the East.

1974 Revolution in Portugal brings down the military dictatorship, resulting in the collapse of Portugal's overseas empire.

1975 The moderate Democratic Union of Timor (UDT) stages a coup in East Timor, demanding independence from Portugal. Civil war breaks out between the UDT and the anti-Indonesian movement FRETILIN.

1975 FRETILIN proclaims the independence of the Democratic Republic of East Timor. Indonesian forces invade East Timor. The Portuguese break off diplomatic relations with Indonesia.

1976 UN Security Council adopts a resolution calling on Indonesia to withdraw all its forces from East Timor without delay.

1976 President Suharto declares East Timor to be a province of Indonesia.

1986 FRETILIN and UDT agree to coordinate their efforts to resist the Indonesians.

1988 Indonesian government allows foreign access to East Timor for the first time in 13 years.

1991 Indonesia agrees to allow a delegation from Portugal to visit East Timor. Trip is canceled after Indonesia objects to a member of the delegation.

1991 Indonesian troops open fire on a crowd of mourners in Dili, killing at least 50 people. Australia and Indonesia

conclude an agreement over the Timor Gap, an area of rich oil deposits.

1992 FRETILIN leader José Xanana Gusmão captured near Dili.

1993 Gusmão given life sentence.

1994 Indonesian military holds talks with the imprisoned Gusmão on possibility of UN referendum on East Timor.

1996 East Timor's international profile is raised when exiled resistance leader José Ramos Horta and Bishop of Dili Carlos Belo are jointly awarded the Nobel Peace Prize.

1998 Indonesian president Suharto resigns.

1999 Pro-Indonesian militias stoke violence against independence activists. People of East Timor vote overwhelmingly for independence. UN peacekeeping force takes over. Ramos Horta returns to East Timor from exile. Xanana Gusmão is released.

2002 Gusmão is named president of a fully independent East Timor.

2004 Production at Bayu Undan offshore gasfield begins.

2005 UN peacekeepers leave.

2006 Agreement with Australia divides resources in the Timor Sea. Serious clashes in Dili involving former members of the army.

2006 Foreign troops arrive in Dili to end widespread violence involving former soldiers. Prime minister Alkatiri resigns over his handling of the unrest and Jose Ramos-Horta takes over as prime minister.

2007 Ramos-Horta wins presidential elections. Xanana Gusmão is named the new prime minister.

2008 Ramos-Horta is seriously wounded in an attack on the presidential palace by rebels. The joint Indonesian–East Timorese Truth Commission report blames Indonesia for human rights violations on East Timor in 1999.

DECISIVE MOMENT

EAST TIMOR VOTES FOR INDEPENDENCE, 1999

On August 30, 1999, in a vote with a staggering 99 percent turnout, four out of every five East Timorese voters chose independence from Indonesia. The vote dramatically marked the end of Indonesia's 23-year occupation of the country. The struggle for independence had cost more than 100,000 lives. Euphoric crowds took to the streets of Dili to celebrate (right) but violent clashes instigated by the Indonesian military broke out soon afterward. An Australian-led peacekeeping force restored order and international outrage soon led to Indonesia withdrawing its troops.

